deep to reach the ground water. Instead, people got their water from the Tamra nala, a rivulet which flowed outside the city.

Where a row of chambers fronted the houses it is assumed they served as shops, positioned as they were along public pathways. House H has a row facing the First Street and another adjacent to Lane 1.[41] Living rooms and bedrooms are more difficult to identify. The rooms to the front are described as living rooms because they were positioned towards the street. Tiny rooms, Marshall felt, could not either serve as living or sleeping rooms because they were too small. His assumptions are not based on anything other than the positioning and size of the rooms.

Can we identify the people, *en masse*, who occupied these blocks? How, for instance, do we recognize the administrators of the city and their official areas of work? This is not easy since there are neither names nor dates for those who occupied public office—neither in inscriptions nor texts. Their presence can in some instances be inferred in a general way from the paraphernalia of administration, such as seals and coins. Seals, though, were used by all kinds of people, for example to authenticate quality by manufacturers and traders, and as a marker of kingship. Taxilan seals are of various types but they never bear names or designations; they are etched with a variety of symbols. Hypothetically, if the same symbols were found on the coins of the Mauryan era, it would suggest the seals were used by administrators—a congruence absent here. It is likely that the seals were primarily commercial in function.

One would expect at least a few of the public buildings to be different in appearance from the dwelling units. But none, with the exception of shops that front streets and lanes, differ from each other, the unvarying look being that of a series of house blocks. Some of these may have housed administrative staff: the complex of rooms centring around Block A, suggested the archaeologist Ahmad Hasan Dani—he reinterpreted the data that Marshall had excavated—was not a domestic unit. Located at the